Dear Editors,

We submit "The Review-Execution Gap in Agentic Software: Approval Scope and Recovery" as a new submission following withdrawal of our earlier submission to Automated Software Engineering (Submission ID: 2015e621-fe12-49d8-b28b-6560d16fe4b1). Please consider the manuscript as a Research Article.

Agentic workflows can regenerate or resume proposed updates after human approval. A correct final value therefore does not establish that the executed candidate was covered by the review. Our study examines how an application's declared approval scope governs admission at a durable execution boundary and how agents continue after an instance mismatch.

The paper develops a four-role correction contract connecting the machine proposal, authorized correction, reviewed candidate, and persisted transition. We compare approval scopes while holding authority, freshness, atomicity, and provenance obligations fixed. Relational and event-journal implementations, bounded formal checks, a configured ToolGate adaptation, and pinned SDK probes provide complementary evidence about persistence, implementability, reviewed-argument consumption, and continuation routes.

In a reduced agent host with a deterministic reviewer, 32 delivered identity-only substitution pairs span 16 task definitions. All instance-bound continuations recover: 24 reuse the reviewed candidate and eight obtain fresh authorization, although reuse remains available and visible in every episode. These continuations require additional tool calls without an established task-completion advantage. The findings concern controlled admission and recovery behavior; they do not establish production effectiveness, stable model preferences, or benefits and costs for human reviewers.

The study fits the journal's interest in formal foundations, software validation, and collaborative automated systems by connecting an enforceable execution contract with observed agent continuation. The manuscript identifies version-pinned data and software in the project repository. Editable sources, archived evidence, and offline reproduction instructions accompany the submission as supplementary resources. The manuscript also includes authorship, funding, competing-interest, ethics, and AI-use declarations.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Sincerely,

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